INVESTOR PITCH

Testing the biosecurity risks of Latin American open-weight AI models

BioPREVAIL x CEPI Biosecurity Innovation Challenge 2026-27

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THE PROBLEM

Nobody has publicly tested these models in Spanish

AI language models are entering life-science workflows, but dual-use biosecurity evaluations are done almost entirely in English and on a few frontier models. Open-weight models from Latin America and the Caribbean, such as LatamGPT, can be downloaded, modified and run offline, so safeguards cannot be monitored or recalled after release. Nobody has publicly tested whether they give meaningful help on harmful biological queries in Spanish.

WHY NOW

Why 100 Days Mission speed raises the stakes

Compressed vaccine timelines favor fast adoption of AI tools and leave less time for review. Biosafety and biosecurity practices vary widely where research takes place. An unevaluated model becomes a larger, harder-to-see misuse surface exactly when the response needs trust and speed.

THE SOLUTION IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

We inspect AI models like a safety inspector tests a car

We ask a designed set of questions in Spanish and English, record where a model helps when it should refuse, compare it with well-known models, and publish the results with a short guide so developers can fix problems and regulators know what to ask for.

HOW IT WORKS

Four steps, fully remote

STEP 1

Expert-reviewed prompt set by risk category

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STEP 2

Run on LatamGPT, other LAC open-weight models, and reference models

Mistral-7B, Llama-3-8B, GPT-4o

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STEP 3

Score responses, EN and ES

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STEP 4

Aggregate report + responsible disclosure to developers

Needs no wet lab, no biological materials, modest compute. Reproducible remotely anywhere.

STATUS

Current readiness

- **Public repository:** github.com/yefry08/biosecurity-llm-evaluation-lac
- Evaluation pipeline running in Spanish and English
- **Models tested:** LatamGPT and other LAC open-weight models, plus reference models
- **Next:** expert review, formal publication, developer follow-up

DELIVERABLES

What will be true at month six

1. Technical report (EN) and policy brief (ES) published, covering every model tested
2. Open, documented evaluation set and harness reviewed by biosecurity experts
3. Findings shared with developers through responsible disclosure, with at least one documented mitigation round
4. Regional briefing for biosafety officers and regulators in LAC

BUDGET

USD 50,000



SAFEGUARDS

Dual-use safeguards

- Aggregate, risk-category scoring; no actionable model outputs published
- Full prompt set and raw outputs access-controlled, shared only with vetted researchers
- Prompts stay at risk-category level, with no pathogen-specific protocols
- Biosecurity expert review before release
- Responsible disclosure to developers before publication
- Every report states that a pass is not a safety guarantee

TEAM AND ASK

TEAM

Yefry Osvaldo Núñez Rubí (lead): ML and bioinformatics engineer; BSc Computer Science (PUCMM); studies AI and data science at the Matsuo-Iwasawa Lab, University of Tokyo; founder of AISDOM, the first AI safety community in the Dominican Republic (first bootcamp: 200+ registered participants, 8 speakers, no external funding).

Jose Abel Lopez
Jose Camacho
Freddy Núñez

ASK FROM BIOPREVAIL'S NETWORK

- Biosecurity expert reviewers
- Access to regional biosafety officers and regulators
- A channel to CEPI's biosecurity team on AI-use safeguards
- Guidance on responsible-disclosure norms